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November 7, 1980
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. DDD-C-001374(GSA-FSS)
August 15, 1967

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CLOTHS, CLEANING, WAFFLE, COTTON

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers cotton waffle weave cloths primarily used for dishwashing, dusting, and scrubbing.

1.2 Classification. Cloths shall be of one type in the following cut size:

18 x 36 inches.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, for a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specification:

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumlative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification, other Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston; New York; Washington, DC; Philadelphia; Atlanta; Chicago; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth; Houston; Denver; San Francisco; Los Angeles; and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection By Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

Application for copies should be addressed to the Federal Trade Commission, Washington, DC 20036.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, NY, Washington, DC 20036

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Recovered materials. The manufacturer shall utilize recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable.

3.2 Figures. The illustrations in figure 1 are furnished for guidance to the contractor. In the event of differences between the written specification and a figure, the written specification shall govern.

3.3 Materials.

3.3.1 Cloth. The basic cloth used for the fabrication of cut to size cloths shall be 100% cotton woven with a honey comb weave and shall conform to the requirements shown in table I. The cloth shall be bleached or unbleached, and unshrunk.

TABLE I

Weight oz/yd^2	Yarns per inch minimum		Ply minimum		Breaking strength minimum lbs.	
	warp	filling	warp	filling	warp	filling
6.5	37	24	2	2	55	45

3.3.2 Thread. Sewing thread used for finishing the edges of the cloth shall be soft finish, white, unbleached, or tinted cotton, 3 ply, Z twist, ticket No. 30 or 40 and shall conform to the requirements shown in table II.

TABLE II

Ticket no.	Approx. tex g/km	Length per lb (yd.)	Min. breaking strength (lbs) force	Newton(N)
30	67	6441 - 8400	3	13.3
40	54	8401 - 10080	2.1	9.1

3.4 Edge finishing of cloths. All raw edges shall be over-edge stitched with not less than 8 stitches per inch. Stitch type No. 1 and stitching type No. 1 as shown in figure 1 shall be used. Ends of stitching shall be secured by backtacking 1/4 inch when not caught in other stitching.

3.5 Size (finished). The size of the finished cloths shall be 18 by 36 inches with an acceptable tolerance of plus 1 inch or minus 1/4 inch in either or both directions. Where selvages are prevalent, they will be acceptable, and are inclusive of the required dimension.

3.6 Fiber identification. One finished cloth in each unit package of one dozen cloths shall be marked for fiber content in accordance with the Rules and Regulations under the Textile Fibers Products Identification Act.

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3.7 Absorbency. The cloths shall be considered absorbent to water when meeting the requirements of the test specified in 4.4.5.

3.8 Workmanship. The cloths shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The cloths shall be free from defects that will affect their serviceability or end use.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein.

4.2 Inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection and testing. Inspection shall be performed on components and materials listed in table I for the characteristics shown and the inspection level shall be S-3 of MIL-STD-105 with an AQL of 6.5 percent defective. The methods of testing, as applicable, shall be as specified in 4.4.1 through 4.4.5. The number of specimens to be tested from each sample unit is specified in the individual test method. All test reports shall contain the individual value utilized in expressing the final result. All tests shall be performed on the sample under ambient conditions of 21.1°C ± 1.1°C and 65 ± 2 percent relative humidity.

4.2.1.1 Certificate of compliance. The physical requirements specified in table II shall be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certification of compliance.

4.2.2 Examination. The required number of units shall be examined on both sides. Defects appearing on both sides of the cloths shall be tallied only once.

4.2.2.1 Visual. The required number of cloths shall be inspected and the defects as listed in table III shall be counted regardless of their proximity to each other, except when two or more defects represent a single local condition of the cloth, in which case only the most serious shall be counted.

4.2.2.2 Dimensional examination. Any finished dimension inclusive of selvages, less than specified shall be classified as a defect.

TABLE III

Any dirt or other foreign matter appearing on cloths.
Any holes or tears in the cloths.
Overstitching missing.
Less than 8 stitches per inch.
Wrong stitch or stitching type.
Loose stitch tension resulting in insecure edging.
Tight stitch tension (stitches break when normal strain is applied to stitching).
Skipped, broken, or runoff stitching more than 1/2 inch.
Ends of stitching not secured.
Any needle chew likely to develop into a hole.
Color other than unbleached or bleached.

TABLE IV. Inspection of physical characteristics

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Weight	Table I	4.4.1
Yarn/ply	Table I	Visual
Yarns per/inch	Table I	4.4.2
Breaking strength	Table I	4.4.3
Weave	3.3.1	Visual
Fiber identification	3.3.1	4.4.4
Absorbency	3.7	4.4.5

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4.2.2.3 Compliance with Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act. During the dimensional inspection one cloth in each unit package of one dozen cloths in the sample shall be inspected for compliance with Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act. Each unit package not labeled in accordance with this Act shall be a defect. The lot shall be unacceptable if two or more of these defects occur.

4.2.2.4 Certification. A certificate shall be submitted with each bid specifying that the material to be supplied will contain the percentage of recovered materials required herein.

4.3 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of section 5. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective.

4.4 Test Methods.

4.4.1 Weight per square yard. Five specimens, each 4 square inches in area shall be tested. Weigh the specimen to the nearest 0.01 g. Calculate the weight per square yard in ounces from the following formula:

$$\text{weight oz/yd}^2 = \frac{\text{weight of specimen in grams} \times 1296\ \text{in}^2/\text{yd}^2}{\text{Area of specimen in in}^2 \times 28.35\ \text{g/oz}}$$

The weight per square yard shall be the average of the five specimens tested, reported to the nearest 0.1 oz.

4.4.2 Yarns per inch. Five specimens, each one inch square shall be tested in both the warp and filling directions. Use a pick glass or other form of counting device. Count the number of warp yarns, then the filling yarns in the specimen. The number of yarns per inch shall be the average of the results obtained from the specimens tested. Report results separately in each direction for warp and filling to the nearest whole number of yarns.

4.4.3 Breaking strength. Five specimens each from both filling and warp directions shall be tested. The specimen shall be 4 inches by 6 inches with the longer dimension parallel to the direction being tested. Use a machine in which the specimen is held between two clamps and strained by a uniform movement of the pulling clamp under constant-rate-of-extension (CRE). The pulling clamp shall have a uniform speed of 12 ± 0.5 inches per minute. Start the test with the jaws of the machine 3 inches apart. Apply force to break the specimen and record the value of the force. The breaking strength shall be the average of the five specimens tested, reported to the nearest 1.0 pound.

4.4.4 Fiber Identification. Take one specimen from the sample unit and mount at least 13 fibers on a microscopic slide. Immerse the fibers in 3 or 4 drops of Herzberg's stain, cover with a cover glass, and allow to stand for 1 to 2 minutes. Examine the prepared slide microscopically at a magnification range of 100x to 500x. Compare the microscopic appearance of the specimen with the standard slide prepared from commercial cotton in the same manner as the specimen. Report results as pass or fail.

4.4.5 Absorbency test. Wash a 6 by 6 inch sample in soap and water by any appropriate washing machine method for not less than 30 minutes, and then dry. The washed, dry sample shall be laid on a flat surface and several drops of water applied. If the water spreads or fans out into the surrounding cloth within 30 seconds the cloth shall be considered absorbent. If the water if not absorbed, but rolls or otherwise spreads on top of the cloth, the cloth shall be considered nonabsorbent.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

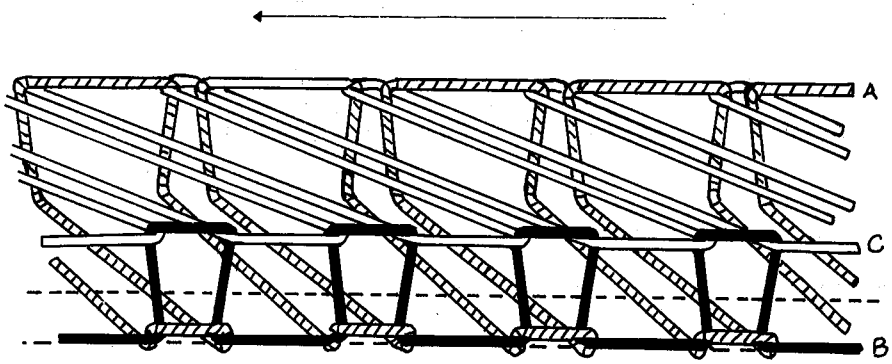
5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B or commercial as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. The cloths shall be folded in approximately 18 inch squares. Twelve cloths of like description shall then be wrapped in plain kraft wrapping paper or polyethylene film and secured with pressure sensitive adhesive tape. Quantities of this package of cloths of like description as specified in the contract or order shall then be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, style optional. Closure and sealing of the boxes shall be in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.1.2 Level B. The cloths shall be folded in approximately 18 inch squares. Twelve cloths of like description shall then be wrapped in plain kraft wrapping paper or polyethylene film and secured with pressure sensitive adhesive tape.

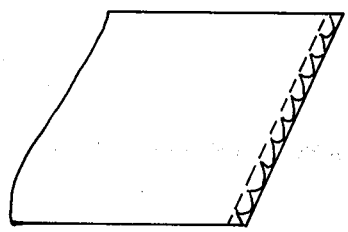
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DIRECTION OF SUCCESSIVE STITCH FORMATION



Stitch type #1

This type of stitch shall be formed with three threads: one needle thread, A; one looper thread, B; and one cover thread, C. Loops of thread A shall be passed through the material and extended to the edge where they shall be interlooped with loops of thread B. The loops of thread B shall be brought up to the top edge of the material and there interlooped with loops of thread C. The loops of thread C shall be extended to the point of needle penetration of the next stitch and there interlooped with thread A.



Stitching type #1

This type of stitching shall be produced by placing a row of stitches over the edge of the material.

FIGURE 1

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5.1.3 Commercial. The cloths shall be packaged in accordance with normal commercial practice. The complete package shall be designed to protect the cloths against damage during shipment, handling, and storage.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or commercial as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Cloths of like description, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in quantities specified in the contract or order in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, style optional. Closure, waterproof sealing and reinforcing of the boxes shall be in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Cloths of like description, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in quantities specified in the contract or order in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, style optional. Closure of the boxes shall be in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Commercial. Cloths of like description, packaged as specified in 5.1 packed in fiberboard boxes to insure delivery at destination; provide for redistribution by the initial receiving activity, and be acceptable by common carrier under the National Motor Freight Classification and Uniform Freight Classification.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. Interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The cloths covered by this specification are primarily intended for scrubbing, dishwashing, and dusting.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
b) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
c) Marking required (see 5.3).

DOD coordination has been waived.

CIVIL AGENCIES COORDINATING ACTIVITIES

GSA-FSS
COM-NBS
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